

Glossary of Common Hospitality and POS Terminology

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BOH - Back of House

Description: FOH means Front of House, which refers to the public parts of bars and restaurants that guests interact with. Think of the dining room, bar, cocktail area, and patio.

FOH - Front of House

Description: The front-of-the-house (FOH) is the customer-facing portion of a restaurant. The front of the house includes the host/hostess, waitstaff, and bartenders. FOH staff are responsible for greeting guests, taking food and drink orders, and ensuring guests have a positive dining experience.

Gateway – Payment Gateway - Transafe

Description: A payment gateway is a technology merchants use to accept customer debit or credit card purchases. The term includes the physical card-reading devices found in brick-and-mortar retail stores and the payment processing portals found in online stores.

Failover Wireless –

Description: Internet failover employs one or more backup Internet connections for redundancy, enabling your connectivity to access – or “failover to” – another network connection when your primary connection fails.

RMA – Return Merchandise Authorization

Description: RMA stands for Return Merchandise Authorization. It is a process that returns a product for a refund, replacement, or repair during the return.

MAC Address –

Description: MAC address is a unique hardware identifier that recognizes devices on a local scale; it is hardcoded into the device during manufacturing

IP Address – Local IP

Description: An IP address is a unique address that identifies a device on the internet or a local network. IP stands for "Internet Protocol,"

Public IP

Description: Public IP addresses are provided by an internet service provider (ISP) and assigned to the router. It is a unique IP address on the Internet. Other machines and websites use a public IP to identify and communicate with the devices connected to a local area network.

LAN – Local Area Network

Description: A local area network (LAN) is a collection of devices connected to one physical location, such as a building, office, or home.

WLAN – WiFi or Wireless Network

Description: A wireless local-area network (WLAN) is a group of collocated computers or other devices that form a network based on radio transmissions rather than wired connections. A Wi-Fi network is a type of WLAN; anyone connected to Wi-Fi while reading this webpage uses a WLAN.

HAAS – Hardware as a Service

Description: Hardware-as-a-service (HaaS) is a procurement model that is similar to leasing or licensing in which hardware that belongs to a managed service provider

SAAS – Software as a Service

Description: Software as a service (SaaS) allows users to connect to and use cloud-based apps over the Internet. Typical examples are email, calendaring, and POS.

GM – General Manager

Description: Restaurant General Managers are responsible for leading and managing restaurants. They may be responsible for different tasks such as restaurant marketing strategies, recruiting and hiring restaurant staff, training, overseeing food quality, developing menus, and greeting and serving restaurant guests.

MOD- Manager on Duty

Description: A person at a facility in charge of operations and guest relations for a certain period. RELATED TERMS: DUTY MANAGER

86'd –

Description: Eighty-six or 86 is American English slang used to indicate that an item is no longer available, traditionally from a food or drinks establishment, or referring to a person or people who are not welcome on the premises.

SN – Serial Number

Description: A serial number is a unique number that records information like the production date and the product's warranty status. Each product has only one corresponding serial number.

POS - Point of Sale

Description: A system restaurants use to process sales transactions, manage orders, track inventory, and handle payment processing.

CRM - Customer Relationship Management

Description: Software used to manage and analyze customer interactions and data, helping restaurants build and maintain customer relationships.

KDS - Kitchen Display System

Description: A digital display used in restaurant kitchens to manage and organize orders and facilitate communication between front-of-house and back-of-house staff.

POS Integration

Description: Integrating various restaurant systems, like online ordering, payment processing, and inventory management, into a single POS system for seamless operations.

CMS - Content Management System

Description: A platform that allows restaurants to manage their website's content, including menus, promotions, and other information.

API - Application Programming Interface

Description: A set of rules and protocols that enable different software applications to communicate and interact with each other.

POS Terminal

Description: The physical device at the restaurant's front counter where staff can enter orders and process payments.

CRM Software

Description: Software designed to help restaurants collect and manage customer data, preferences, and interactions for personalized marketing and service.

QR Code Menu

Description: Customers can access a digital menu by scanning a QR code using their smartphones.

Online Ordering Platform

Description: A web or mobile application that allows customers to place orders for delivery or pickup from a restaurant's menu.

Waitlist Management System

Description: Software used to manage and organize customer waitlists for busy restaurants, optimizing seating arrangements and minimizing wait times.

POS Cloud System

Description: A cloud-based POS system that stores restaurant data and information online, allowing for remote access and real-time updates.

POS Hardware

Description: The physical devices used with the POS software, such as touch screen monitors, receipt printers, and card readers.

SMS Marketing

Description: A marketing strategy that sends promotional messages and offers to customers via text messages.

Loyalty Program

Description: A reward system implemented by restaurants to encourage repeat business and customer loyalty.

Online Reservation System

Description: A platform that enables customers to book tables at a restaurant through the restaurant's website or app.

3rd Party - Food Delivery Aggregator

Description: An online platform that consolidates multiple restaurant menus for customers to order from various establishments in one place.

PCI DSS - Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard

Description: A set of security standards to protect cardholder data during credit card transactions and payment processing.

Common Abbreviations and Acronyms

1. **POS (Point of Sale):** The location where a transaction occurs between a merchant and a customer.
2. **EMV (Europay, Mastercard, and Visa):** A global standard for credit and debit card payments using chip card technology.
3. **PCI-DSS (Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard):** A set of security standards designed to ensure that all companies that accept, process, store, or transmit credit card information maintain a secure environment.
4. **NFC (Near Field Communication):** A set of communication protocols that enable two electronic devices to communicate when they are within close proximity.
5. **MSR (Magnetic Stripe Reader):** A device used to read the information encoded in the magnetic stripe on the back of a credit or debit card.
6. **ECR (Electronic Cash Register):** A device used for recording sales transactions and processing payments.
7. **OTA (Online Travel Agency):** A website or platform that sells services related to travel, such as accommodation, flights, and car rentals.
8. **B2B (Business-to-Business):** Transactions or operations conducted between businesses.
9. **B2C (Business-to-Consumer):** Transactions or operations conducted between a business and individual consumers.
10. **API (Application Programming Interface):** A set of tools and protocols for building software applications, allowing different software systems to communicate with each other.

Common Terms

1. **Merchant Account:** A type of bank account that allows businesses to accept payments by credit or debit cards.
2. **Payment Gateway:** A service that authorizes credit card or direct payments processing for online and brick-and-mortar businesses.
3. **Chargeback:** A transaction reversal meant to protect consumers from fraudulent activity, which requires the merchant to return the amount of the transaction to the cardholder.
4. **Interchange Fee:** A fee paid between banks for the acceptance of card-based transactions.
5. **Batch Processing:** The processing of multiple transactions at once, typically at the end of a business day.
6. **Tokenization:** The process of replacing sensitive data with unique identification symbols (tokens) that retain all the essential information about the data without compromising its security.
7. **Settlement:** The process by which a merchant receives funds from transactions processed through their POS system.

8. **Receipt Printer:** A printer connected to a POS system used to print transaction receipts for customers.
9. **Inventory Management:** The process of ordering, storing, and using a company's inventory, including the management of raw materials, components, and finished products.
10. **Loyalty Program:** A rewards program offered by a business to customers who frequently make purchases.
11. **Tip Adjustment:** A feature allowing the addition of a tip to a credit card transaction after the initial authorization.
12. **Split Tender:** A payment method where a transaction is divided into multiple forms of payment.
13. **Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC):** A service that allows international customers to see the cost of a transaction in their home currency at the point of sale.
14. **Refund:** The return of funds to a customer, typically in the same form as the original payment.
15. **Gift Card:** A prepaid card that can be used as an alternative to cash for purchases within a particular store or related businesses.
16. **Customer Relationship Management (CRM):** A system for managing a company's interactions with current and future customers.
17. **Cloud POS:** A point of sale system that uses cloud technology to process and store transaction data, accessible via the internet.
18. **Integrated Payments:** Payment processing that is seamlessly incorporated into a merchant's software or POS system.
19. **E-commerce:** The buying and selling of goods and services over the internet.